

Xavier Grimsby

Character Dossier

Methodical and secretly sentimental lighthouse keeper of Verdance, a floating garden city

Overview

Xavier Grimsby is a lighthouse keeper living in Verdance, a floating garden city. Xavier is 72 years old, originally from Bittermoor, and is known around the Canopy Walk as methodical and secretly sentimental. In conversation Xavier compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Background

Xavier arrived in Verdance, a floating garden city 20 years ago after leaving Bittermoor under circumstances Xavier describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Verdance Stewardship; the second was the one that stuck. Today Xavier works as a lighthouse keeper near the root-cellar markets and is paid, when paid at all, in seed-notes.

Xavier learned the trade from Qadira Lindqvist, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Xavier's life is with Katarina Achterberg, over a matter neither will explain. The person Xavier trusts most is Ravi Castellan.

Current goal: to be forgotten by the people who remember the fire. Greatest fear: owing anything to the Verdance Stewardship.

Personality and speech

Temperament: methodical and secretly sentimental.

Speech pattern: Xavier compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Tells: when lying, Xavier mentions Comet the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Xavier Grimsby
Role	lighthouse keeper
Home	Verdance, a floating garden city
Hometown	Bittermoor
Age	72
Favourite dish	the tavern's clam fritters
Pet	Comet, a hedgehog

<i>Lucky number</i>	526
<i>Workshop password</i>	cove-lattice
<i>Mentor</i>	Qadira Lindqvist
<i>Rival</i>	Katarina Achterberg
<i>Closest friend</i>	Ravi Castellán

Secret

Xavier sold a family heirloom to pay for Ravi Castellán's medicine and told everyone it was stolen.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Xavier: I am the lighthouse keeper. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Xavier: The tavern's clam fritters. Do not tell Katarina I said so.

Visitor: Is Comet yours?

Xavier: Comet belongs to nobody. Comet tolerates me. Lucky number is 526, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 30

Xavier found a cracked compass half-buried near the pollinators' hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the comet flared up between Xavier and a neighbour outside the pollinators' hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Xavier and a neighbour outside the pollinators' hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Xavier moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. Xavier found a bundle of letters half-buried near the pollinators' hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 2, summer of year 30

The weather turned. Xavier moved the iron kettle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Xavier and a neighbour outside the Canopy Walk; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the old tunnels. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 3, autumn of year 30

At the pollinators' hall, Xavier taught a newcomer how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Xavier was hired to carry a spool of wire from the pollinators' hall to the root-cellar markets without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier found a hand bell half-buried near the pollinators' hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, autumn of year 30

A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Xavier and a neighbour outside the root-cellar markets; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Xavier repaired the pair of spectacles at the root-cellar markets for Imogen, who paid in 81 seed-notes and a long story about the singing at the docks. At the root-cellar markets, Xavier taught a newcomer how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 5, summer of year 31

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the census. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier repaired the spool of wire at the tether docks for Sixten, who paid in 66 seed-notes and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Xavier has a suspect and is probably right. Dashiell came by asking about the singing at the docks. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 6, autumn of year 31

At the pollinators' hall, Xavier taught a newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Xavier moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt. The weather turned. Xavier moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 7, summer of year 31

Xavier repaired the oilskin map at the pollinators' hall for Phaedra, who paid in 20 seed-notes and a long story about the right way to mend a net. At the pollinators' hall, Xavier taught a newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Xavier closed early, walked to the Canopy Walk, and watched the lights come on. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the pollinators' hall: 72 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short.

Entry 8, autumn of year 31

Xavier spent the day counting stock at the Canopy Walk: 65 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the Canopy Walk: 69 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Xavier repaired the tin whistle at the Canopy Walk for Calloway, who paid in 35 seed-notes and a long story about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Canopy Walk. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 9, summer of year 32

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rowan came by asking about the comet. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Xavier moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment.

Entry 10, autumn of year 32

Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Xavier has a suspect and is probably right. Xavier closed early, walked to the root-cellar markets, and watched the lights come on. Qadira came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. Winifred came by asking about the singing at the docks. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 11, autumn of year 32

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the harvest count. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Xavier has a suspect and is probably right. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the root-cellar markets. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.